

» PERCH AND RELATIVES

**SPOTTED CTENOPOMA**

Ctenopoma acutirostre
F: Anabantidae

This tropical freshwater fish is found in the Congo basin of Africa. It often stalks its prey with its head held down.

12 cm
4 3/4 in

**SIAMESE FIGHTING FISH**

Betta splendens
F: Osphronemidae

The original range of this Asian freshwater fish is unclear, but it has been bred for centuries for its fighting ability, particularly strong in males.

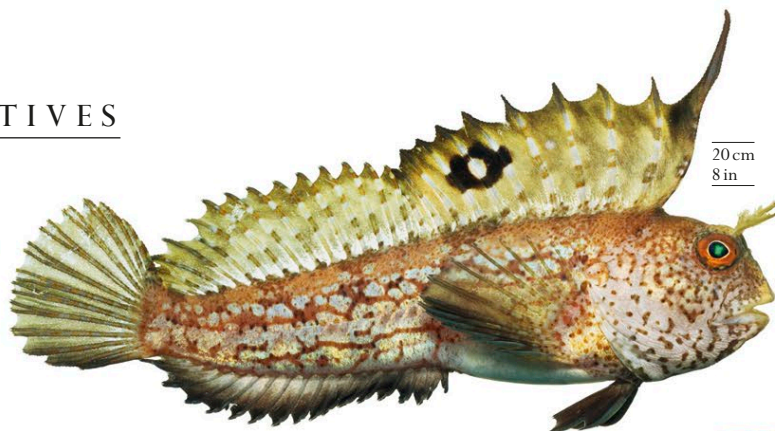
6.5 cm
2 1/2 in

**POWDERBLUE SURGEONFISH**

Acanthurus leucosternon
F: Acanthuridae

This Indian Ocean fish has a sharp blade-like structure sheathed on either side of its tail base, which it can flick out to slash a would-be attacker.

23 cm
9 in

**BUTTERFLY BLENNY**

Blennius ocellaris
F: Blenniidae

Like many of its relatives, this fish of the N.E. Atlantic lives on the seabed and guards its eggs, which are often laid in an empty shell.

20 cm
8 in



FIREFISH
Nemateleotris magnifica
F: Microdesmidae

9 cm
3 1/2 in

Hovering above its coral reef burrow, this fish gathers plankton from the water and darts back into safety if it senses danger.

elongated first ray on dorsal fin



6 cm
2 1/4 in

MANDARINFISH

Synchiropus splendidus
F: Callionymidae

Native to the Pacific, this is one of the most colourful of all tropical reef fish. Its vivid colours warn predators of its foul taste.



3.2 m
10 ft

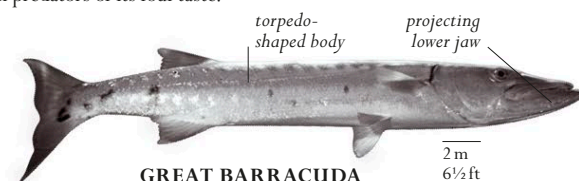
ATLANTIC SAILFISH

Istiophorus albicans
F: Istiophoridae

This ocean predator uses its upper jaw, which extends as a long spear, to slash into shoals of fish and stun them.

spear-shaped snout

huge, sail-like dorsal fin



2 m
6 1/2 ft

GREAT BARRACUDA

Sphyræna barracuda
F: Sphyrænidae

Found globally in tropical and subtropical waters, this solitary predator stalks its prey and then accelerates rapidly as it strikes.

torpedo-shaped body

projecting lower jaw



60 cm
23 1/2 in

ATLANTIC MACKEREL

Scomber scombrus
F: Scombridae

Living in large shoals in the North Atlantic, this fish feeds voraciously on small fish and plankton. Its streamlined body makes it a fast swimmer.

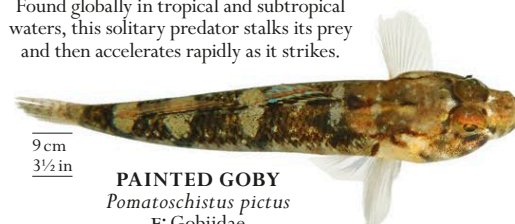


4 cm
1 1/2 in

BUMBLEBEE FISH

Brachygnathus dorsalis
F: Gobiidae

Found in S.E. Asia, this bottom-dwelling goby is tolerant of brackish water and lives in estuaries and mangroves.



9 cm
3 1/2 in

PAINTED GOBY

Pomatoschistus pictus
F: Gobiidae

This and other similar gobies are common in shallow sediment areas of the N.E. Atlantic. DNA analysis suggests gobies might be placed in a separate order, Gobiiformes.

high-set, bulbous eyes



4.5 m
15 ft

NORTHERN BLUEFIN TUNA

Thunnus thynnus
F: Scombridae

Found globally, this tuna is one of the world's most valuable commercial fish. A fast, dynamic predator, it roams widely, hunting small fish.



long tail

25 cm
10 in

ATLANTIC MUDSKIPPER

Periophthalmus barbarus
F: Gobiidae

As long as it stays moist, this mudskipper can stay out of water for hours by absorbing oxygen through its skin.